

50TH ANNIVERSARY

POLITICS
2015-2025 | OPPOSITION |

THE BOGEY THAT WAS I.N.D.I.A

After a brief challenge in the 2024 general election, the promise of the 26-party-strong alliance as a credible Opposition is rapidly fading

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the summer of 2023, a year before the general election, the sun could hardly have shone brighter. Twenty-six political parties, burying their disparate ideologies and differences, came together to take on a single, seemingly indomitable adversary. The coalition even gave itself a grand name—the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance, the cleverly crafted backronym I.N.D.I.A. signalling unity, ambition and national purpose.

A year earlier, in September 2022, Rahul Gandhi had embarked on a Bharat Jodo Yatra, a 150-day, 4,080-km walkathon that saw him journey from Kanyakumari to Kashmir, covering 12 states and two Union territories. The march of unity generated enough momentum and goodwill to spark talk of a Rahul resurgence. The Congress leader also championed the cause of a nationwide caste